

**DIGITAL WORKPLACE MANAGEMENT IN A HYBRID
WORKING ENVIRONMENT ACROSS SERVICE SECTOR**

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

Ms. Ravina Narayanan

(Register No: 2015782022035)

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Under the guidance of

**Dr. Prabakaran. P, MBA, MSc Psychology, PGDPMIR, DCA,
SET, PhD.**



P.G DEPARTMENT OF HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

MADRAS SCHOOL OF SOCIAL WORK

(AUTONOMOUS)

No. 32, CASA MAJOR ROAD, EGMORE

CHENNAI-600008

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project titled “**DIGITAL WORKPLACE MANAGEMENT IN A HYBRID WORKING ENVIRONMENT ACROSS SERVICE SECTOR**” is a bonafide project work done by **Ms. Ravina Narayanan** (Reg no:2015782022035), a second year student of M.A. HRM, Madras School of Social Work (Autonomous), Egmore, Chennai in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the Award of the Degree of Master of Arts in Human Resource Management and that the project has not been used previously for the award of any Degree, Diploma, Scholarship, Fellowship or any other project title.

Signature of the HOD

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Signature of the Principal

DECLARATION

I, **Ravina Narayanan**, final year student of **M.A. HRM** hereby declare that the thesis entitled “**DIGITAL WORKPLACE MANAGEMENT IN A HYBRID WORKING ENVIRONMENT ACROSS SERVICE SECTOR**” is the original work done by me under the guidance and supervision of Dr. Prabakaran, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Master of Arts in Human resource Management, Madras School of Social work. I further declare that the research work has not been submitted at any other University or Institution, for the award of any degree or diploma or fellowship.

Signature of the Guide

Signature of the Student

PLACE: CHENNAI

DATE:

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Chapter – I

Introduction

1.1 Introduction:

The onset of the COVID-19 pandemic has forced the world to change in so many unprecedented ways which has pushed organizations and managers to chalk out a way to manage their employees, get work done and also maintain the productivity and profitability of the organization. This directed the organizations in exploring and implementing employee friendly flexible work plans that helps meet the rapidly changing environment. After a year of remote work, the organizations are bracing themselves for a new major style of working, the hybrid model. After a lot of analysis, organizations have realized that the hybrid model is here to stay which means organizations will have to reimagine their success strategies and will also have to change their entire structure of working starting from cultural aspects to leadership styles, workplace management, communication etc.

A hybrid workplace or a hybrid working environment is a course of action where employees go to the workplace incidentally and complete the remainder of the errand by telecommuting relying upon their comfort. It is nearly another idea that the associations embrace to execute a smoother work process while managing the pandemic. It is the future of work giving employees the flexibility of location allowing companies to tap on a larger talent pool, giving everybody equal opportunities and encouraging communication.

The hybrid work environment for the most part permits representatives the chance to fit work around their lives, instead of organizing work around fixed hours signed into an office. For some representatives (and managers) it's an ideal offset of useful work with diminished pressure and less driving.

1.2 Need and scope of the study:

Understanding the hybrid workplace is the need now than ever because organizations are just starting to transition to the hybrid working model and are trying to understand and sketch out a way to make the fullest use of this new model of working while ensuring the productivity stays intact and that employees are able to transition smoothly into this new model.

The scope of this study is extended to discovering where every employee works to her best using competency management program. It helps organizations to track and manage the skills, knowledge and expertise of employees, understand their working styles eventually leading to capturing the best practice. The scope also extends to benchmarking the necessary infrastructure, skills and tools that is needed for employees to function smoothly in a collaborative manner in a hybrid working environment. It also enables the human resource department to come up with learning and development initiatives for a hybrid workplace and how to provide them to all employees irrespective of where they work from. It also brings light to managers on how to manage their subordinates, combat proximity bias and make sure all employees are given equal visibility and opportunities.

It also helps managers and organizations to devise a strategy to take advantage of the different places and times in which employees work by increasing energy for people working remotely, promoting coordination towards synchronous work and as well making sure employees stay focused during asynchronous work and also encourage unity for employees in-office. Understanding hybrid working environment also throws light to managers that mechanism of measuring productivity has changed to focusing on outcomes than by measuring the number of hours an employee has worked or tasks completed. This means that this study also paves way towards increasing the sense of accountability and responsibility among employees.

A greater sense of understanding of the hybrid workplace helps recruiters of the human resource department to refresh job descriptions making a larger pool of talent fit to their criteria. The scope of this study is also extended to organizations realizing the dynamic nature of a hybrid workplace and will enable them to keep their operations and aspects of workplace management more fluid and easier to changes.

1.3 Importance of the study:

Understanding the hybrid workplace is important because the right kind of hybrid workplace can be of tremendous use to the organization. Understanding the hybrid workplace is important because:

- It reduces operations costs to a great extent by saving on real estate and office maintenance costs
- It increases productivity of the employees
- It enables easy cross-collaboration of teams
- It helps save employees financially like reduction in commuting costs etc.
- It enables easy cultural transition that will suit the hybrid working environment
- It helps the organization to reshape their goals and objectives that will survive through this new change
- It helps in maintaining greater transparency among employees
- It helps form proper communication channels to ensure everyone is kept on loop
- It helps employees and organization to enhance flexibility in their schedule giving employees a sense of greater work-life balance
- It helps organizations prepare themselves to invest in necessary tools to ensure smooth running of operations

- It provides employees with stronger work-life balance
- It helps organizations build a crisis resilient way of working and functioning

1.4 Statement of research problem:

As organizations move into the hybrid working environment, employees will be working out of different locations i.e., from office and at home. This poses quite some challenges to the organization in aspects of workplace management:

- Infrastructure: Organizations should ensure that employees working from home have the same or all the necessary infrastructure that an in-office employee is provided with. This includes a proper office desk setup at home along with needed electronic gadgets like laptop, tablet, mobile phone etc., and as well a perfectly working internet connection to make the working atmosphere as comfortable and easy as possible.
- Communication and collaboration: As half the employees are working out of office and half the employees are working from home, they should all be brought to a common platform for communication. This ensures that no matter where the employee works out of, everyone receives first hand update information from the organization/ manager. Also, as most of the employees are part of teams, proper communication and collaboration is required so that employees are able to coordinate with each other well and that the work is carried out seamlessly. Organizations must ensure to invest in appropriate communication and collaboration tools to allow employees to work together in teams, to give opportunity for the employee to be heard in case of any ideas, suggestions or grievances, to receive all necessary communication on time and to combat proximity bias i.e., making sure every employee is

equally considered for new opportunities and employees are equally recognized for the work they do.

Hence, this study is conducted to know how hybrid working environment affecting these variables of workplace management and what are the steps taken by the organization to reduce these challenges.

1.5 Industry profile:

Service sector is the part of the economy that creates services that are intangible. Service dominated economy are associated with developed countries whereas less developed countries are more agricultural and industrial based. The service sector is the 3rd sector of economy after agriculture and manufacturing. It is the largest sector of the global economy in terms of value.

Rther than producing products, this sector provides service experiences like consulting, user experience etc. countries globally like the United States, United Kingdom, Australia, China etc., place heavy importance on the service sector. The United States in fact even has Institute for supply management (ISM) set up to provide a monthly index containing details of the general state of business among the service sector which is used as a metric for the overall economic status of the country as 2/3rd of the country's economy revolves around the service sector.

Technology in the service sector:

The information technology systems are truly shaping the way businesses function in the service sector. It is increasingly focusing on becoming as the knowledge economy, or by understanding what customers want and accordingly operate to meet those wants with minimal cost. The idea is to function with the notion that 'customer is the king' in order to be able to surpass competitors. Nearly all industries in this sector adopt to newer technology to increase

production, speed, efficiency and cut down on costs and the number of employees becoming more automated. This in turn improves the revenue.

Service sector in India:

The service sector isn't just the prevailing area in India's GDP, but has also drawn in critical unfamiliar venture, has contributed altogether to trade and has given enormous scope business. India's administrations area covers a wide assortment of exercises like exchange, lodging and cafés, transport, stockpiling and correspondence, financing, protection, land, business administrations, local area, social and individual administrations, and administrations related with development.

a) Market Size:

Portion of the service sector represented 55.39% of the all out GVA in FY21. India's administrations area GVA expanded at a CAGR of 11.43% to Rs. 101.47 trillion (US\$ 1,439.48 billion) in FY20, from Rs. 68.81 trillion (US\$ 1,005.30 billion) in FY16. Somewhere in the range of FY16 and FY20, monetary, land and expert administrations expanded at a CAGR of 11.68% (in Rs. terms), while exchange, inns, transport, correspondence and administrations identified with broadcasting rose at a CAGR of 10.98% (in Rs. terms).

As indicated by RBI, in April 2021, administration trades remained at US\$ 21.17 billion, while imports remained at US\$ 10.61 billion.

The India Services Business Activity Index/Nikkei/IHS Market Services Purchasing Managers' Index tumbled to 46.4 in May 2021 from 54.0 in April 2021, as yield and new orders declined because of COVID-19-incited limitations to contain the spread of Covid.

b) Industry Developments:

Some of the developments in the service sector in the recent past are the following:

- In June 2021, India's exports expanded by 48.34% to US\$ 32.5 billion, denoting the seventh sequential month of development.
- The services classification in India pulled in combined unfamiliar direct venture (FDI) worth US\$ 87.06 billion between April 2000 and March 2021. The services category positioned first in FDI inflow according to information delivered by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT).
- In April 2021, the Ministry of Education (MoE) and University Grants Commission (UGC) began a progression of online collaborations with partners to smooth out forms and processes to lessen consistence trouble in the higher education area, as a development to the public authority's attention on simplicity of working together to empower simplicity of living for stakeholders.
- On March 17, 2021, the Health Ministry's eSanjeevani telemedicine administrations crossed 3 million (30 lakh) teleconsultations since its dispatch, empowering patient-to-specialist discussions from the bounds of their home and specialist to-specialist interviews.
- In April 2021, Elon Musk's SpaceX has begun accepting pre-orders for the beta variant of its Starlink satellite network access in India for a completely refundable store of US\$ 99. Presently, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) is screening the move and more improvements will be uncovered soon.
- In December 2020, an accomplice of six wellbeing tech new companies—AarogyaAI, BrainSightAI, Fluid AI, InMed Prognostics, Wellthy Therapeutics, and Onward Assist—have been chosen by the India Edison Accelerator, fueled by GE Healthcare. India Edison Accelerator, the organization's initial

beginning up association program zeroed in on Indian guides, makes vital accomplices to co-foster medical care arrangements.

- The Indian medical care industry is relied upon to move carefully empowered far off counsels through teleconsultation. The telemedicine market in India is relied upon to increment at a CAGR of 31% from 2020 to 2025.
- In December 2020, Gamma Skills Automation Training presented an exceptional mechanical technology and mechanization profession dispatch program for engineers, an 'Industry 4.0 Hands-on Skill Learning Center' situated at IMT Manesar, Gurgaon in Haryana.
- In December 2020, the 'Touch off' program was started by Siemens, BMZ and MSDE to energize top notch preparing and specialized training. 'Touch off' plans to foster profoundly prepared professionals, with an accentuation on preparing them for the business and future, in light of the German Dual Vocational Educational Training (DVET) model. By 2024, this program means to upskill ~40,000 representatives.
- In October 2020, Bharti Airtel entered cloud correspondences market with the dispatch of business-driven 'Airtel IQ'.

c) Government Initiatives:

The Government of India perceives the significance of advancing development in the service sector and gives a few impetuses across a wide assortment of areas like medical care, the travel industry, schooling, designing, interchanges, transportation, data innovation, banking, money and the executives among others.

The Government of India has embraced not many drives in the new past, a portion of these is as per the following:

- As per a representative, the Indian government is wanting to present a credit motivator program worth Rs. 50,000 crore (US\$ 6.8 billion) to help medical care framework in the country. The program will permit organizations to get to assets to increase clinic limit or clinical supplies with the public authority going about as an underwriter.
- In June 2021, India and Australia declared its coordinated effort in digital empowered basic advances, featuring the prerequisite to help the basic data security foundation, for example, 5G telecom organizations.
- Under Union Budget 2021-22, the public authority dispensed Rs. 7,000 crore (US\$ 963.97 million) to the BharatNet program to support advanced availability across India.
- FDI limit for insurance agencies has been raised from 49% to 74% and 100% for protection intermediates.
- In May 2021, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry declared that India got a FDI inflow of US\$ 81.72 billion, the most elevated FDI during FY 2020-21.
- In March 2021, the focal government mixed Rs. 14,500 crore (US\$ 1.99 billion) capital in Central Bank of India, Indian Overseas Bank, Bank of India and UCO Bank through non-premium bearing bonds.
- On January 15, 2021, the third period of Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) was dispatched in 600 locale with 300+ ability courses. Initiated by the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, the third stage will zero in on trendy and COVID-related abilities. PMKVY 3.0 expects to prepare eight lakh up-and-comers.

- In January 2021, the Department of Telecom, Government of India, marked a MoU with the Ministry of Communications, Government of Japan, to fortify collaboration in the space of 5G advancements, telecom security and submarine optical fiber link framework.
- On November 4, 2020, the Union Cabinet, led by the Prime Minister, Mr. Narendra Modi, supported to sign an update of comprehension (MoU) between the Ministry of Communication and Information Technology and the Department of Digital, Culture, Media and Sports (DCMS) of United Kingdom Government to participate in the field of broadcast communications/data and correspondence advancements (ICTs).
- In October 2020, the public authority chose Hughes Communications India to interface 5,000 town panchayats in line and naxal-influenced states and island domains with satellite broadband under BharatNet project by March 2021.
- In September 2020, the public authority reported that it might implant Rs. 200 billion (US\$ 2.72 billion) in open area banks through recapitalization of bonds
- In the following five years, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology is attempting to expand the commitment of the advanced economy to 20% of GDP. The public authority is attempting to construct cloud-based framework for collective organizations that can be utilized for the making of imaginative arrangements by AI business visionaries and new companies.
- On Independence Day 2020, Prime Minister Mr. Narendra Modi declared the National Digital Health Mission (NDHM) to give a one-of-a-kind wellbeing ID to each Indian and upset the medical services industry by making it effectively open to everybody in

the country. The strategy draft is under 'public interview' until September 21, 2020.

- In September 2020, the Government of Tamil Nadu declared another gadgets and equipment fabricating strategy lined up with the old arrangement to build the state's hardware yield to US\$ 100 billion by 2025. Under the strategy, it plans to meet the prerequisite for steady human asset by upskilling and preparing >100,000 individuals by 2024.
- Administration of India has dispatched the National Broadband Mission with an intend to give Broadband admittance to all towns by 2022.

d) Future Ahead:

By 2025, medical care industry is expected to arrive at US\$ 372 billion. India's digital economy is assessed to arrive at US\$ 1 trillion by 2025. By end of 2023, India's IT and business administrations area is relied upon to arrive at US\$ 14.3 billion with 8% development.

The execution of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) has made a typical public market and decreased the general taxation rate on products. It is relied upon to lessen costs over the long haul by virtue of accessibility of GST input credit, which will bring about the decrease in costs of services.

1.6 Chapterization:

Chapter 1: The first chapter deals with Introduction, Need and Scope of study, Importance of the study, Profile of the Industry and also the sector/organization where the research was undertaken and finally the chapterization.

Chapter 2: The second chapter gives an elaborate literature survey of the subject under study.

Chapter 3: The third Chapter deals with the Research Methodology, Sampling Techniques, Sample size, Pilot study, Sample Elements and Limitations.

Chapter 4: The fourth chapter contains a data analysis of the research findings and their corresponding interpretation.

Chapter 5: The fifth chapter summarizes the findings, Suggestions and conclusions.

Chapter – II

Review of literature

2.1 Introduction:

Throughout this chapter, the researcher probes into the background of the research area. The core objective of the literature review is to acquire knowledge, get better understanding of implications in the field of research by studying about the similar studies done by the other researchers. Literature reviews on the other hand helps to understand objectives, scopes, constructs, research models, analysis, findings and suggestions of the selected areas of study. This literature review looks at how workplace management is changing and evolving in a hybrid working environment.

2.2 Literature Review:

Corrin Jones (2021), in his article on how to effectively manage a hybrid workplace model enunciates the challenges in a hybrid work environment which includes difficulty in communication, more time to touch base on aspects of collaboration and employees tending to feel alienated and apart. However, he also provides certain tips on how to manage the hybrid workplace like:

- Shifting focus from the number of hours worked to milestones and deadlines achieved and measuring productivity and achievements than raw time as the human brain can only do focused work for a certain number of hours no matter where the employee works from.
- Utilizing communication and collaboration software like office 365 and MS teams that acts as a consistent method of communication which provides an integrated platform for employees regardless of whether they are remote or in office.
- Encouraging team engagement and team building activities, exercises and shared goals so that employees don't feel left out.

- Building trust between employers and employees and not micro-managing employees as it simply doesn't work in a hybrid environment. Managers would rather have to play a role of a facilitator by ensuring their employees have what it needs to succeed rather than questioning the employees' ability to self-govern.
- Having frequent check in with employees to ensure that are getting what they need in terms of resources, infrastructure etc.
- Having processes in place to monitor and manage communication by making clear channels of communication, whom they should contact incase they need guidance, raise a complaint or seek approval etc.

Mark Mortensen and Martine Haas (2021), in their article have given their viewpoints and ideas on how to make the hybrid workplace fair. They talk about how hybrid provides organizations with benefits like labor-cost optimization, increased flexibility, increased employee satisfaction and reduced carbon footprint while also challenges in maintaining critical strengths of smoother coordination, stronger cultural socialization, greater creativity, informal networking and face-to-face collaboration. In order to lead the hybrid environment, they say that managers should know how to manage 2 distinct sources of power: *hybridity positioning and hybrid competence*.

Hybrid positioning is basically the visibility and resource accessibility level of the employee that gives employees chances in a new project, update information, recognition for good work and credits. This visibility tends to be more if the employee is working out of office or is in the same location as the manager while managers have very little visibility over employees working remote where no matter how hard or how many late nights and early mornings the employee has worked, their efforts remain unseen. Hence, it is important that managers understand the concept of hybrid positioning to ensure equal recognition and opportunity for all.

Hybrid competence is the employees' ability to be adaptive and flexible to changing environments, to be good at communication, relationship building, establish and provide evidence that build trustworthiness even in a context of low visibility etc. While employees who naturally possess these skills tend to collaborate and transcend the gap, not all employees are strong in these skills which puts them in a place where they feel constantly out of sync. Hence, it is the responsibility of the managers and the organization to bridge this workplace gap to ensure everybody is moving along the same line.

Disha Gupta (2021), in her article has provided her viewpoints on how to implement a hybrid workplace model in which she has pitched 3 models on how this could work.

First, the “remote- first” model is somewhat closer to a fully remote company but with certain exceptions. In this model, employees work across different time zones and collaborate online while ensuring that their productivity is not compromised and that the targets are achieved within the stipulated time frame.

Second, the “occasional- office” model. This model might be preferred by some companies that are eager to get back to office for reasons like not wanting to lose money on unused office spaces or fearing their close competitors who have brought their employees back to office. In this model, the employees come to office few times a week depending on the organization's requirements or project work. This model ensures that the employees gain the advantages of remote work like flexible timings etc. while also not losing out on the office experiences like water cooler conversations etc.

Third, the “office- preferred, remote- allowed” model. This model already existed even before the pandemic where office is the primary space for working and employees can choose to work from home under specific circumstances.

However, in this model, the employees working from home might lose out on a lot of career advancement opportunities and recognition from their superiors.

Nenad Lazarevic (2021), in his Forbes article talks about the hidden traps of managing a hybrid workforce that may challenge companies to land on the most effective hybrid structure and keeping employees in sync when they are in and out of office. He talks about 4 major traps:

First, he talks about how companies might assume to believe that the company's culture will take care of itself. Culture is a very volatile concept that depends on a lot of factors like leadership, work environment, hiring choices etc. that affects how the workplace functions in an organization and this aspect might take a hit if the organization is not careful about it. Companies will have to ensure that remote employees have the same opportunities as in-office staff and in-office staff should be assured that remote employees are being held accountable as much as they are.

Second, he talks about how companies should think and plan contextually on their hybrid structure as to how many employees should work out of home and from office depending on daily activities and preferences of the company.

Third, he talks about segmenting productivity and performance data like employee monitoring, productivity analysis, time tracking, project management tools etc., based on the working locations add break down data based on the differences.

Lastly, he talks about how rigidly sticking to a hybrid structure is never a good concept as hybrid working environment in itself is a very fluid and hence, we might have to keep changing it as per the requirements of the employees and company.

Vikas Kalwani (2021), in his article talks about how communication should be a hybrid workplace and discusses in the key aspects of setting up communication in a hybrid workplace.

Keeping a hybrid ready tech stack is very important as it will be the platform on which we will be bringing both remote and if-office workers together. Thus, it is essential to invest on some team chat tool or software. There should be a clear communication process set up with easy access to resources and information so that employees can work asynchronously, reduce communication gaps and misunderstandings and as well be clear of the goals expected to achieve. Face to face communication is extremely important when the situation calls for it as it will be beneficial for both the company as well as the employees. Certain employee benefits such as contribution towards home office set up or travel expense allowances must be provided to remote and hybrid workforce by the company to ensure seamless workflow and as well helps to boost the productivity and engagement of the employees. It is highly essential for the organizations to become feedback driven to make sure all employees are in line and mistakes if any can be immediately rectified. It also helps the employees to improve and embrace this new way of working. Finally, leaders must treat all employees the same way and ensure that employees are kept on loop with communication no matter where they work from.

Camille Hogg (2020), in her article provides her viewpoints on the future of work and 5 ways in which she feels hybrid workplace will reshape communication in an organization:

Firstly, communication will be a lot more asynchronous by default as work doesn't happen at the same time for all employees. Communication has to be more intentional and for topics that are not time sensitive, organizations should encourage their employees to put forth more refined written communication that can precisely convey their ideas and thoughts without any misinterpretation.

Organizations should also invest in good technology that facilitates options such as a shared inbox etc.

Secondly, written communication is most likely to become the norm for most organizations. In hybrid workspace, it is most likely that information can be misheard, miscommunicated, or lost in transition. Thus, documenting the knowledge and resources in the form of written communication makes it easier for employees to access resources and information. Hence, traditional ways like taking minutes of the meeting might come in very handy to make sure information is passed on to everybody.

Thirdly, there will be a lot of awareness on tone of communication. Since people can interpret the same message in multiple ways, there should be a lot of clarity and empathy in written communication as they are a vital source of knowledge and information.

Fourthly, different messages would require different formats and employees should be aware of it. There will be use of multiple communication methods depending on the context of the information. Hence it is important that organizations build a framework around the various communication tools and technology and how best it can be used.

Lastly, it is important for organizations to communicate with equity in mind. It is important for organizations to ensure no body is feels left out or misses any communication. Though communication is a lot harder online, the organizations should ensure employees feel a sense of belonging for driving employee engagement. Organizations should foster more equitable and inclusive communication that will remove as many barriers as possible and should also understand how different individuals prefer to communicate and must customize communication as per the needs of the employees.

Kristina Martic (2021), in her blog suggests ways to ensure smooth transition into the hybrid working model so that employees can quickly adapt to this new form of workplace. To tap into some of the benefits of hybrid working environment like better employee experience and wellbeing, increased employee engagement and productivity, easier talent attraction and better retention etc., organizations must meet certain basic requirements to get this new form of working up and running. In this blog, 8 such ways are mentioned for the smooth transition:

- Understanding employees' needs and preferences with respect to their engagement and productivity level, nature of work etc.
- Setting and communicating clear goals and expectations, mission, vision etc. to make sure all employees are aligned and objectives are achieved no matter where they work from.
- Establishing proper employee communication channels and treating it as a top priority. Investing on proper communication technology.
- Getting frequent feedbacks from employees on employee wellbeing, motivation, engagement, collaboration and productivity through surveys/ 1-1 calls etc.
- Constantly giving employees guidance through new rules, policies, procedures etc., to make sure employees have clarity at all times.
- Reducing biases and discrimination in terms of opportunities and productivity based on the place they work from.
- Introducing and providing new benefits and perks for employees like home office supplies, mental health services etc.
- Constantly updating organization's tech stack to make sure all employees have equal access to update information.

Rebecca Weintraub and Steven Lweis (2021), in their article give their insights on how informal communication can be encouraged in a hybrid workplace that will make collaboration and feedback so much easier. Recognizing information haves and have nots brings to the company's notice that people working remote do not have much faster access to information as people in office do and thus can encourage more informal communication among remote employees that will enhance spontaneity of new ideas and creative solutions. The company will also have to plan for such unplanned informal conversations so that no employees are left out of the loop.

The company can come up with "magic days" where is not all, most employees gather physically once a month to have informal conversations and discuss ideas and projects so that when they again resume back to being in office or remote, they will be able to run on common specifics discussed in the meet. The key is to create such opportunities so that employees are forced into a common area and eventually interactions happen.

Another way is to provide personalized training to employees on hoe to make their hybrid teams effective and engaged. Getting ideas and suggestions from the employees themselves is a great way of doing as it allows maximum participation and engagement as is as well very likely to suit the employees. Such training should be made synchronous. Employees will have to be given clear expectations of how the entire workplace would work hybrid, how they can communicate, collaborate and navigate themselves through this new way of working and as well what is expected out of them and what they are accountable for.

Mohammad Saiedur Rahman et al., (2020), in their study researched on the seating preference analysis for hybrid workplaces. Various parameters regarding seating preferences like sitting next to team members, closer to the window, in an open area, near to the friends etc. Since, covid restrictions have

brought about a lot of restrictions with regard to workplace, especially the in-office set up, there are a lot of factors to be taken into consideration before realigning the office space. No doubt the seating arrangement, the office set up etc., have a lot of impact on the productivity of the employees but it is also important to ensure safe working spaces for all employees.

According to a conduct perspective, the gathered dataset features the mind-boggling significance of vicinity to colleagues and staying associated with partners just as being found close to windows. This proposes that the achievement of working environment plan depends on working on normal light admission and border zone seating, just as a functional administration methodology to guarantee work areas are distributed suitably for groups inside an association. In different words, an open arrangement office game plan whereby anybody can settle down anyplace however they see fit, conceivably adverse consequences on usefulness by not controlling group plans.

Future work environments should likewise consider and plan for restricting usefulness limitations. The dataset shows that by and large, ecological components - aside from clamor - are not as huge as functional and balance between serious and fun activities factors. That is, efficiency limitations are more related to how gatherings and undertaking resourcing are overseen, as opposed to comfort factors. Notwithstanding these plan factors, the dataset proposes the significance of human asset the executives and creating constructions and frameworks to limit project numbers and gatherings for every laborer. Subsequently, half breed work environments where more individuals will keep working from in the future can presents a chance for businesses to work on their laborer's focus and efficiency levels past what is conceivable in a business office.

Banu Saatci et al., (2019), in their research share stories of success and failure of hybrid meetings in the modern workplace and present some insightful

findings. Hybrid gatherings, in which co-found and far off members associate through video or/sound, have become universal in the globalized current work environment. Regardless of, or maybe due to this pervasiveness, directing half breed gatherings isn't clear. In this paper, the chances and difficulties of half and half gatherings is researched. A multi-site investigation of crossover gatherings in two worldwide programming organizations in Europe was held, utilizing member perception, semi-organized meetings and video-examination. The discoveries show that there is a huge variety in arrangements and prerequisites for cross breed gatherings in various work spaces. Further, cross breed meeting members see and handle a scope of both expected and new issues. While a few issues can be ascribed to hardships or disappointments of specialized framework, others emerge out of imbalances of collaboration and social and social setting across the co-found and far off settings. It was contended that dealing with these imbalances is vital to an effective hybrid gathering.

Jessica Galang (2021), discusses about how communication and empathy is the key to retaining talent in a hybrid workspace. In the article, she discusses about the concept of having intentionality and clarity in communication and how communicating in advance is really important for a seamless flow of work in the organization. No doubt the concept of overcommunication is really essential in today's style of working and in a hybrid workspace, it is all the more important to ensure everybody receives the information at the same time.

Levelling the field for remote and in-office workers is really important to have a balanced workspace. Not only in terms of opportunities and recognition, but also systems like performance evaluation should be based on a pre-determined set of parameters and competencies rather than just the subjective rating of the manager to make sure no subjective biases affect the employee.

Overall, striking a balance is very important in a hybrid working environment as it is constantly changing and there is no one size fits for all model of hybrid

working. The company and the employees should be willing to adapt from time to time as the situation demands while ensuring that the employees' productivity remains unaffected.

Patrick Ward and Victoria Zelefsky (2021), in their Forbes article give in their suggestions on how to create a community in a hybrid workspace in which they primarily focus on highlighting the teams' success internally and empowering managers. Creating an internal platform where success of individual employees/ teams can be shared is very essential so that people know the contribution done by each employee no matter where they work out of and it is also easier for managers to take notice on a uniform platform of how his employees are performing for recognition and opportunity. The role of a manager can tremendously help an employee in transitioning into the hybrid working model and as well affect the entire experience of his at the company. Thus, the managers can be oriented and trained as to how the entire system will work in a hybrid workplace so that he knows how to handle his employees in terms of communication, networking and working together with their remote reports.

Martha Maznevski and Katherine Chudoba (2000), in their research study about bridging the space over time among global virtual teams to increase their effectiveness. During the research period, organizations were just starting to go global and thus it became a mandate for organizations to implement decisions regarding international components and policies. The research was based on adaptive structuration theory that involved investing in communication tools and changing the structure of organizations according to the changes of globalization. Today, this is the essential need of organizations and is applicable even with employees belonging to the same geographical zone. The research primarily focuses on effective interaction through virtual communication

mediums as well as its sync with regular face-to-face communication to see aspects like how fast the communication happens, how much the members are in the loop with follow up conversations etc., to see the gap if any and come up with effective solutions to bridge the gap to ensure both virtual and face-to-face communication are as equally effective as possible.

Viviane Clement and Jorge Rivera (2017), in their article “From Adaptation to Transformation: An Extended Research Agenda for Organizational Resilience to Adversity in the Natural Environment” intend to support examination into how associations can deal with their strength because of antagonistic conditions originating from the natural environment. While firms might have an overall capacity to adapt to negative working conditions, transformation to biological difficulty specifically may really confront genuine restrictions. Utilizing an interdisciplinary methodology that draws from strength hypothesis in socioecology, this article fosters a few lines of request. To begin with, they recognize the instruments by which hierarchical strength might vary as firms adjust to changing degrees of environmental difficulty. Second, they recommend that the current conceptualization of authoritative versatility could be extended to incorporate extraordinary change, which might permit firms to relieve the functional effects of arriving at transformation limits. At last, they consider the flexibility ramifications of the interdependency among firms and the more extensive environments in which they work.

Bryan Borys And David B. Jemison (1989), enunciate that the pressing factors firms face to recharge their capabilities, to enter into new item market fields, to manage asset requirements, and to create universally frequently are all around met by hybrid arrangements. These plans, thus, present new and significant difficulties to researchers and managers. For managers, hybrids are turning out to be more significant as essential choices, however they are a condition for

which managers' previous experiences and psychological guides have not satisfactorily prepared them.

For researchers, hybrid work environment challenge existing hypothesis to clarify the unique elements of hybrid purpose, boundaries, value creation, and soundness.

Conventional hierarchical and key management hypotheses offer a few experiences, yet they are restricted in their materialness to the instance of hybrids since they manage unitary organizations and, hence, don't resolve the extraordinary issues raised by an organization made out of at least two sovereign organizations. Albeit past endeavors at characterizing hybrids have produced some forceful thoughts, hierarchical examination has needed a precise hypothetical system for mixture examination.

The study focused on four ideas: the expansiveness of hybrid purpose and the cases and plans that it legitimates, the permeability of hybrid-accomplice limits, the interdependence of team activities in the value creation measure and the intricacy of the arrangements needed to oversee it, and the idea of the hybrid's soundness. Not exclusively is every one of these issues huge by its own doing, in any case, it should be additionally shown that understanding the associations among them offers insights into hybrids.

Dr. Holly Birkett et al., (2021), in their research propose their findings and recommendations for post-pandemic hybrid working based on changes in attitudes and intentions like flexible working, increased focus on goals achieved that presenteeism, increase in trust among managers and employees etc. the following are the recommendations provided in this study:

- Enabling conversations among employees and managers to understand each other's situations and difficulties and come up with a mutually beneficial outcome and plan for working.

- Thinking how hybrid working benefits the business in the maximum possible way through flexible working to ensure maximum retention.
- Making hybrid working policies more family friendly.
- Enabling an inclusive design structure of hybrid working so that no employee feels left out.
- Providing training to managers on how to manage their hybrid working employees.
- Revise the existing performance appraisal mechanism in which the review parameters suit hybrid working.
- Providing training on data security to all employees.
- Keep in mind to promote gender equality in flexible working and recruitment policies.
- Ensure proper work environment and infrastructure to ensure employees have all the facility they need to work hybrid.
- Reviewing communication channels and processes and investing on communication tools.
- Keeping in mind the legal issues that can arise out of hybrid working.
- Modifying culture according to the hybrid working environment.

Monika Grzegorzczak et al., (2021), in their study discuss on how to blend the physical and virtual mode of work for post-pandemic working style. For the reasons for examination, conceive the making of an obvious authoritative classification of work: the hybrid working model. In a hybrid model, laborers can use telecommuting for an extent of their contracted working hours inside the constraints of exclusively or altogether arranged work game plans. Those cutoff points could be very much set to 100%, i.e., it could be feasible to visualize mixture laborers who forever telecommuting, collaborating with associates who embrace a diverse blend between time invested dealing with site and energy spent working distantly.

Hybrid work plans ought to contain (on top of standard authoritative terms), the accompanying concurrences on adaptability as far as the spot and season of work:

- Workspace adaptability: Least and additionally most extreme measures of time spent working distantly or at the workplace, including determinations of where the far-off working environment might be found geologically (broadly or universally).
- Work time adaptability: Least and additionally most extreme sums for time spent during or outside of available time.
- Frameworks for fixing and following reality adaptability: Time spans for figuring the sums spend working distantly or non-concurrently (week after week, month to month, quarterly or yearly), and imperatives for the person to consider, including fixed office days for groups, divisions or entire associations.
- Provisions for the far-off working environment: To guarantee that the telecommuting space is protected and solid.
- Provisions for balance between serious and fun activities: To guarantee that limits between work time and individual time are regarded.

Presenting the BBBB challenge: Hybrid models present basic hierarchical difficulties for bosses, identified with the smooth mixing of on location and telecommuters. Those difficulties are regularly gathered into three classifications: blocks, bytes and conduct, i.e., the space, apparatuses and culture of far-off work. To these three classifications, add a fourth: outline, or the designation furthermore, coordination of assignments, jobs and individuals in the new crossover climate.

Huiguo Zhang et al., (2021), propose a hybrid framework for smart and safe working environments in the era of COVID-19. Coronavirus is a serious

irresistible infection which has spread across the majority of the nations and regions on the planet. The infection scourge has completely changed the human way of life for living and working. Individuals need to wear masks in open spaces constantly and ensure distances from one another, to limit the expected danger of infection and guarantee the self-assurance. Work-from-home (WFH) turns into a recent fad for the everyday working style and online correspondence becomes predominant over the eye-to-eye correspondence. While the scourge is as yet progressing, a great deal of associations have mentioned a portion of their representatives work in the workplaces (through group A/B pivot and so on). An exceptionally basic issue for the associations is the means by which to guarantee a protected workplace for the representatives in the plague and post-pestilence periods without costing exorbitant human endeavors and inclusions.

With the improvement of the Internet of Things (IoT), robotics and man-made consciousness, a protected workplace becomes conceivable. Surrounding knowledge assumes a significant part for medical services in the everyday life spaces through sensors and under insight, which additionally motivates the conceivable transformation of the work space. Scientists propose the reception of man-made reasoning and mechanical technology to construct keen workplace. In battling against COVID-19, a part of IoT arrangements have been proposed to screen human exercises through a wide spread of sensors, to upgrade conclusion and treatment, diminish missteps and costs and make control more successful.

For the work space, "brilliant" and "safe" have gotten increasingly more significant since the pandemic than at any other time. "Brilliant" working climate implies that the climate knows about the representatives' exercises and can detect the issues and offenses of the workers at the beginning phase, "Safe" working climate implies that the climate assists with guaranteeing all the wellbeing measures, particularly in the scourge period, for example wearing masks, safe distancing etc.

The fundamental motivations behind the keen and safe workplace configuration are to:

1. Guarantee least and safe human contact;
2. Offload individuals' standard undertakings;
3. Confirm a client's character to limit hazards from outer;
4. Assist workers with developing right conduct standards.

This paper, proposes a crossover system dependent on IoT, humanoid robots and man-made consciousness stage to accomplish a brilliant and safe workplace. A general design is worked to cover every one of the vital modules in the utilitarian pecking order, going from the framework, to information, to AI models, to applications. Rules are given to work with the associations/organizations/establishments to make a comparable arrangement. In addition, moral issues are likewise featured for the brilliant workplace arrangement.

Gernot Grabher and Oliver Ibert (2014), in their study talk about how knowledge and resources can be shared through collaboration in hybrid virtual communities. This article disagrees with the reification of closeness in the current discussions about the geographies of information creation. It targets fostering a more separated view on the spatialities of learning by zeroing in on information rehearses in which neither physical nor social closeness are accessible. All the more explicitly, the article investigates based on a 'netnographic approach' intelligent information coordinated effort in nine 'mixture virtual networks' that mirror an expansive range of hierarchical set-ups from firm facilitated over firm identified with free networks. The exact examination uncovers that mixture virtual networks even without physical or social vicinity can deliver monetarily helpful information; that regardless of the low significance of closeness the physical and material conditions assume an

essential part for information joint effort in hybrid virtual networks; and that half breed virtual networks manage the cost of special specialized freedoms and social elements that encourage learning measures unreachable in vis-à-vis settings.

Hybrid virtual networks can be partitioned into three particular sorts, every one of which is characterized by the sort of connection between business makers from one viewpoint, and clients and excited laypersons on the other. Firm-facilitated networks are started and kept up with by expert and business makers. These organizations set up the online gathering of trade, utilize the local area's mediators, characterize and police the standards of connection and can, whenever considered significant, set the plan by unequivocally requesting input on explicit points. Firm-related networks are dispatched by local area individuals who make and implement the principles of cooperation in a self-coordinated measure. Notwithstanding, these networks are not autonomous from proficient makers. Maybe, the object of normal interest is related with an unmistakable brand or even a explicit item. Rather than the to some extent requested exhortation in firm-facilitated networks, information cooperation regularly unfurls around questions and practices that rise up out of every day usage. At long last, autonomous networks arise and develop without the motivation or help of expert or business associations. Association elements are driven by the inspirations and desires of local area individuals alone. Comparative with the two different kinds of networks, information coordinated effort in free settings is most thoroughly centered around the 'epistemic article' while firm-related networks specifically unfurl solid sidelong elements around off-theme strings or essentially 'commotion'.

Jason Jay (2013), in his study “Navigating paradox as a mechanism of change and innovation in hybrid organizations” emphasizes on the importance for organizations and researchers to be conscious of the assumptions based on which hybrid structure is formed because none of this perception is a standard theory that might suit all organizations. Hybrid environments are complex and

their structuring is based on a lot of internal and external factors and stakeholders. It is constantly dynamic and requires adaptability within the organization and among immediate stakeholders. Ignoring the chances of assumption can lead to unforeseen circumstances such as stuckness, drifting from organizational objectives, internal conflict etc. it might even lead to cultural and behavioral complexity and irrational leadership patterns to navigate the situation. Thus, being open to the dynamics of hybrid environment and as well the opinion and suggestions of internal employees, external stakeholders, research experts etc., is the key to keep the structure as dynamic and effective as possible and also make the fullest potential use of hybrid working environments.

2.3 Summary:

From this review of literature, the research review and viewpoints from a various authors have been provided which has helped to understand about the concept and its variables. The main motive of this chapter is to get a proper understanding about the Hybrid working model and how it has an effect on workplace management and the variables of workplace management such as collaboration, communication, workspace infrastructure etc.

Chapter – III

Research Methodology

3.1 Objectives of the study:

3.1.1 Primary Objective:

To study the digital workplace management in a hybrid working environment across service sector.

3.1.2 Secondary Objectives:

- To identify the variables of digital workplace management.
- To examine the infrastructure variable in hybrid working environment.
- To analyze the aspects of communication of digital workplace management.
- To analyze the aspects of data management of digital workplace management.
- To analyze the aspects of team management of digital workplace management.
- To analyze the effect of infrastructure variable on communication, data management and team management.
- To find out the relationship of age and work experience and communication, data management and team management.

3.2 Hypothesis of the study:

Hypothesis 1:

- **H₀:** There is no effect of infrastructure on communication, data management and team management.
- **H₁:** There is effect of infrastructure on communication, data management and team management.

Hypothesis 2:

- **H₀:** There is no significant difference between the age group with regard to communication, data management and team management.
- **H₁:** There is significant difference between the age group with regard to communication, data management and team management.

Hypothesis 3:

- **H₀:** There is no significant difference between the years of experience with regard to communication, data management and team management.
- **H₁:** There is significant difference between the years of experience with regard to communication, data management and team management.

3.3 Definition of variables:**3.3.1 Hybrid working environment:**

A hybrid working environment is the new-age workplace model that includes a combination of employees spending time in the office and work from home. Employees are given some degree of choice to choose whether they want to work from home or report to the office as long as they are consistent in accomplishing their tasks and meeting goals.

3.3.2 Digital Workplace management:

A digital workplace is an online work space where employees are able to do their job by collaborating, communicating and connecting with others. It is being able to maintain productive business relationships within and beyond natural work groups and enabling knowledge sharing across the organization.

3.4 Research Design:

A research design is the logical and systematic planning and directing of a piece of research. The research design of the present study is analytical in nature. Analytical research involves critical thinking skills and the evaluation of facts

and information related to the research being conducted. This approach focused on the process of the final result rather than giving importance to the result. The cause-and-effect relationship is easily established with the help of the analytical approach. In this study, analytical approach is applicable in all stages of the research work.

3.5 Sampling Method:

The study is based on Non – Probability Convenience Sampling. Convenience sampling is a non – probability sampling technique where subjects are selected because of their convenient accessibility and proximity to the researcher. Likewise, the researcher selected the accessible target group by selecting service sector companies in India and adopted convenience sampling method to achieve the sample size.

3.5.1 Universe of the study:

All items in any field of inquiry constitute a Universe or Population. The population of the research is the employees of different age groups and years of experience working in the service sector organizations in India.

3.5.2 Sample Size:

Sample size acts as the representative population of the whole universe hence the size of the sample is an important factor in determining the validity of the study. The sample size of the study is 100 respondents.

3.6 Methods of Data Collection:

Data is a set of information which enables the researcher to find solution to a problem in hand. No research is said to be completed without data. Data refers to information or facts. Data also includes descriptive facts, non-numerical information, quantitative and qualitative information. The researcher collects data from both primary and secondary data.

3.6.1 Primary Data:

Primary data is a type of information that is obtained directly from first-hand sources by means of surveys, observation or experimentation. It is data that has not been previously published and is derived from a new or original research study and collected at the source such as in marketing. It mainly consists of numerical collections of raw information to be analysed and evaluated. The term primary data may sometimes be used to refer to first-hand information. Such data are collected with specific set of objectives to assess the focus area being studied.

3.6.2 Secondary Data:

Secondary data is research data that has previously been gathered and can be accessed by researchers. Secondary data is readily available from the other sources and as such, there are no specific collection methods. This includes data from articles, journals, magazines, newspapers and internet.

3.7 Tools for Data Collection:

The researcher used ‘Questionnaire’ as an instrument for collecting primary data, which proves to be less expensive and yet elaborative, when compared to other methods. The questionnaire consists of a set of well- formulated questions to probe and obtain responses from the respondents. Questionnaire is an effective data collection mechanism when the researcher knows exactly what is required and how to measure the variables of interest.

The questionnaire in this study contained a total of 30 questions of which the first 2 questions were demographic questions. For the remaining 28 questions, the researcher has used standardized ‘Digital trust in Workplace’ questionnaire by Dave E. Marcial and Markus A. Launer which are based on a five-point Likert-scale by using “Strongly Agree” =5, “Agree” =4, “Neutral” =3, “Disagree” =2 and “Strongly Disagree” =1. The questionnaire was uploaded to

Google forms and it was used as a part of the tool to collect and record data during the survey.

3.8 Statistical tools for Data Analysis:

3.8.1 Percentage Analysis:

Percentage analysis method is usually used for expressing the relative frequency data like survey responses and other data. It displays data specifying the percentage of observations existing for each grouping of data points or a data point. In this study, the percentage analysis is used for data interpretation

Formula: $\text{Number of respondents} \times 100 / \text{Total number of respondents}$

3.8.2 Regression Analysis:

Regression analysis is a set of statistical methods used for the estimation of relationships between a dependent variable and one or more independent variables. It can be utilized to assess the strength of the relationship between variables and for modelling the future relationship between them.

Formula: $Y = a + bX$

3.8.2 One Way ANOVA:

ANOVA which stands for Analysis of Variance is a statistical test used to analyze the difference between the means of more than two groups. A one way ANOVA uses one independent variable. The independent variable should have at least three levels/groups/ categories. ANOVA tells if the dependent variable changes according to the level of independent variable.

3.9 Reliability Test:

Cronbach's alpha is commonly used measure of reliability for a set of two or more construct indicators. With values ranging from 0 to 1.0, the higher value indicates a higher reliability among the items. Cronbach's alpha is used in this research to access the scale's internal consistency in terms of how well the items

measured the same construct or dimension of perceived training quality. Although a commonly used benchmark for acceptable reliability is 0.60, lower values have been deemed acceptable when the research is descriptive in nature. The overall reliability value for this research is 0.930.

Reliability Analysis

Constructs	Items	Reliability Score (Alpha Value)
Digital Workplace	28	0.930

3.10 Limitations of the study:

- Due to the pandemic scenario and lack of physical touch, the researcher couldn't effectively reach out to the target group.
- Information was collected from service sector people on a voluntary basis. Therefore, the responses of service sector employees from all levels could not be covered.
- Due to the strict norms of organizations and closure of organizations due to the pandemic reduced the chances for the researcher to perform data collection physically.
- Data collection through questionnaire was limited only up to 100 respondents.
- Time frame of the study is only one month.

Chapter – IV

Data Analysis and Interpretation

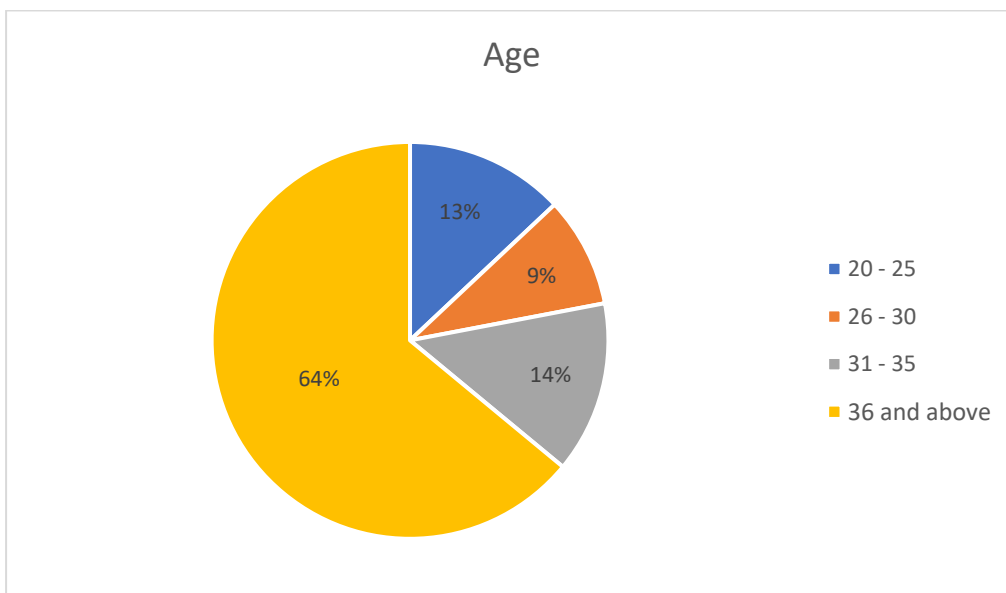
4.1 Percentage Analysis of Demographic Details:

Each question from the questionnaire which is the source of primary data collected is converted in the form of tables. The table illustrates the classification of the data collected and the percentages of data and other relevant statistical information.

Table 4.1 Distribution of respondents based on Age

Age	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
20 – 25	13	13
26 – 30	9	9
31 – 35	14	14
36 and above	64	64
Total	100	100

Figure 4.1 Age wise Classification

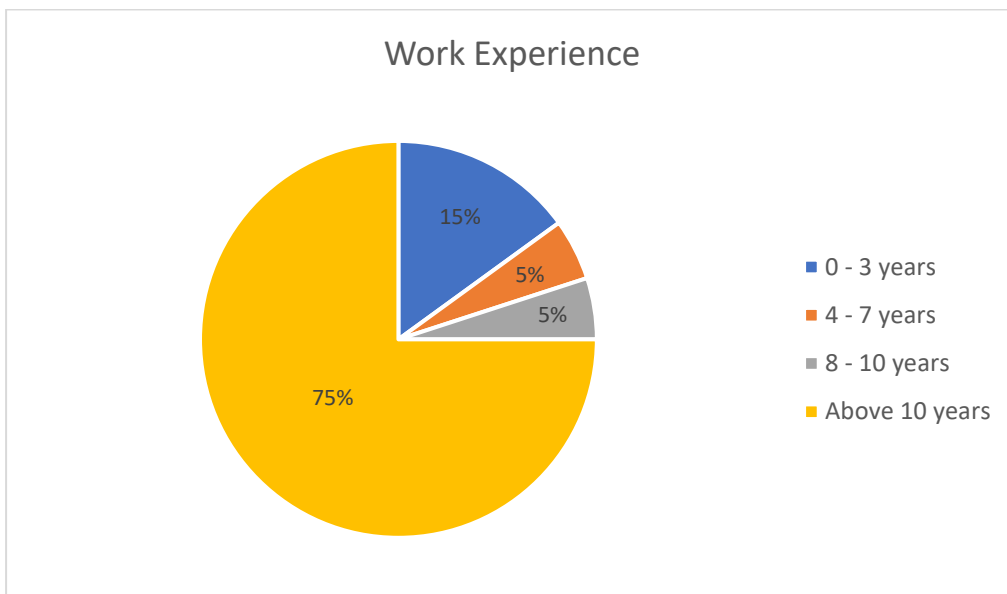


Inference:

It is inferred from the above table that 64% of the respondents belong to the age group of 36 years and above, 14% of the respondents belong to the age group of 31 – 35 years, 13% of the respondents belong to the age group of 20 – 25 years, and 9% of the respondents belong to the age group of 26 – 30 years.

Table 4.2 Distribution of respondents based on Work Experience

Work Experience	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
0 – 3 years	15	15
4 – 7 years	5	5
8 – 10 years	5	5
Above 10 years	75	75
Total	100	100

Figure 4.2 Work Experience of the Respondents

Inference:

From the Table 4.2, it is inferred that 75% of the respondents have above 10 years of experience, 15% of the respondents have 0 – 3 years of experience, 5% of the respondents have 4 – 7 years of experience, and 5% of the respondents have 8 – 10 years of experience.

4.2 Statistical Analysis**LINEAR REGRESSION****Hypothesis 1:**

H₀: There is no effect of infrastructure on communication, data management and team management.

H₁: There is effect of infrastructure on communication, data management and team management.

Table 4.3 Relationship between infrastructure variable on communication

Variables	Unstandardized coefficients		Standardized coefficients	t	Sig.
	Beta	Std. Error	Beta		
Constant	17.109	2.417		7.079	< .001
Infrastructure	.540	.111	.440	4.848	< .001

Dependent Variable: Communication **Level of Significance:** 0.05

Note: R= .440, R²= .193 and Adjusted R²= .185

Inference

From the above table it can be inferred that the t statistics probability value for Infrastructure is $< .001$ which is less than 0.05 level of significance, hence we reject the null hypothesis. Thus, it can be concluded that the infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the communication in the digital workplace. The regression equation can be written as:

$Y = 17.109 + 0.540 X$, where X is the infrastructure and Y is the communication. The value of correlation coefficient (r) is 0.440, coefficient of determination (r^2) is 0.193 and adjusted R^2 is 0.185.

Table 4.4 Relationship between infrastructure variable data management

Variables	Unstandardized coefficients		Standardized coefficients	t	Sig.
	Beta	Std. Error	Beta		
Constant	22.450	1.932		11.623	$< .001$
Infrastructure	.665	.089	.596	7.354	$< .001$

Dependent Variable: Data Management **Level of Significance:** 0.05

Note: $R = .596$, $R^2 = .356$ and Adjusted $R^2 = .349$

Inference

From the above table it can be inferred that the t statistics probability value for Infrastructure is $< .001$ which is less than 0.05 level of significance, hence we reject the null hypothesis. Thus, it can be concluded that the infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the data management in the digital workplace. The regression equation can be written as:

$Y = 22.450 + 0.665 X$, where X is the infrastructure and Y is the communication. The value of correlation coefficient (r) is 0.596, coefficient of determination (r^2) is 0.356 and adjusted R^2 is 0.349.

Table 4.5 Relationship between infrastructure variable team management

Variables	Unstandardized coefficients		Standardized coefficients	t	Sig.
	Beta	Std. Error	Beta		
Constant	14.198	1.705		8.328	< .001
Infrastructure	.515	.079	.552	6.557	< .001

Dependent Variable: Team Management **Level of Significance:** 0.05

Note: $R = .552$, $R^2 = .305$ and Adjusted $R^2 = .298$

Inference

From the above table it can be inferred that the t statistics probability value for Infrastructure is < .001 which is less than 0.05 level of significance, hence we reject the null hypothesis. Thus, it can be concluded that the infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the team management in the digital workplace. The regression equation can be written as:

$Y = 22.450 + 0.665 X$, where X is the infrastructure and Y is the communication. The value of correlation coefficient (r) is 0.552, coefficient of determination (r^2) is 0.305 and adjusted R^2 is 0.298.

ONE WAY ANOVA

Hypothesis 2:

H₀: There is no significant difference between the age group with regard to communication, data management and team management.

H₁: There is significant difference between the age group with regard to communication, data management and team management.

Table 4.6 Table representing significant difference between the age group with regard to communication, data management and team management

Variable	Mean	F	df	Sig.
Communication	28.640	.420	3	.739
Data Management	36.430	1.302		.278
Team Management	25.200	1.750		.162

Level of Significance: 0.05

Inference:

- **Communication:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.739 is more than the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H₀. Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the age groups and communication aspect of digital workplace management.
- **Data Management:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.278 is more than the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H₀. Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the age groups and data management aspect of digital workplace management.

- **Team Management:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.162 is more than the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H_0 . Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the age groups and team management aspect of digital workplace management.

Hypothesis 3:

H₀: There is no significant difference between the years of experience with regard to communication, data management and team management.

H₁: There is significant difference between the years of experience with regard to communication, data management and team management.

Table 4.7 Table representing significant difference between the years of experience with regard to communication, data management and team management

Variable	Mean	F	df	Sig.
Communication	28.640	1.623	3	.189
Data Management	36.430	1.894		.136
Team Management	25.200	2.696		.050

Level of Significance: 0.05

Inference:

- **Communication:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.189 is more than the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H_0 . Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the years of experience and communication aspect of digital workplace management.

- **Data Management:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.136 is more than the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H_0 . Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the years of experience and data management aspect of digital workplace management.
- **Team Management:** From the above table, it can be inferred that the probability value 0.050 is equal the alpha value 0.05, therefore we accept the H_0 . Hence, we conclude that there is no significant difference between the years of experience and team management aspect of digital workplace management.

Chapter – V

Findings, Suggestions and Conclusion

5.1 Summary of Findings:

After a detailed study, the collected information and data was analyzed. The below are the key findings.

Demographic Variables:

- More than half of the respondents (64%) belong to the age group of 36 years and above.
- More than three forth of the respondents (75%) have more than 10 years of work experience.

Findings from statistical analysis:

Collectively analyzing the responses from the respondents using statistical methods, it was found that,

- The infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the communication in the digital workplace.
- The infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the data management in the digital workplace.
- The infrastructure provided in a hybrid working environment influences the team management in the digital workplace.
- There is no significant difference between the age groups and communication aspect of digital workplace management.
- There is no significant difference between the age groups and data management aspect of digital workplace management.
- There is no significant difference between the age groups and team management aspect of digital workplace management.

- There is no significant difference between the years of experience and communication aspect of digital workplace management.
- There is no significant difference between the years of experience and data management aspect of digital workplace management.
- There is no significant difference between the years of experience and team management aspect of digital workplace management.

5.2 Suggestions and recommendations:

Since the future of work is hybrid and hence, a digital workplace is the absolute need of the hour so that employees can connect on a common platform irrespective of where they are working out of. This aspect is quite new and also equally crucial and hence it has to be very carefully and creatively designed to ensure a smooth user experience. Infrastructure like designated desks for in-office employees and a work from home set up for remote employees with all necessary hardware and software is the basic need. However, looking at this research from a much wider scope, here are some of the suggestions that organizations could adopt to make digital workplace so much more efficient:

- **Building a digital workplace with a distinctive, engaging employee experience:** As we recognized that the infrastructure is the most basic need for a digital workplace, it just does not stop with that. It is just as much or rather more important to create experiences that allow employees to collaborate, serve their own information needs, engage in culture and conversations with fellow employees and also provide better support to customers. The workplace has to be more human centered, seamless, easy, secure and connected so that all employees are brought into the loop and none of the employees are left out in terms of receiving timely communication or access to necessary, new and updated data regardless of where people are working out of.

- **Maximizing productivity and engagement in a hybrid workplace:** Employee productivity and retention is always a concern in times of transition and change in the way an organization functions. Hence, a few measures like defining what roles could be done remotely and what roles require in-office presence, keeping a pulse on employee engagement and fulfillment, relaxation on work timings and rather keeping goal achievement as the performance evaluation factor, understanding and addressing changes in workload, building managers into effective leaders who can engage their teams and drive strategy, engaging in informal conversations and empowering employees regardless of where they are working could be some of the methods organizations can adopt to increase productivity and employee retention in the company.
- **Reinventing talent strategy for a hybrid world:** Implementing an organization design and talent strategy with the right leadership is the essential for a hybrid environment. This means learning and instilling new skills that employees need to succeed in a hybrid world, preparing the right culture so that employees are driven to success, updating the employee lifecycle for a hybrid workplace, considering business process outsourcing and contingent strategies to reach advance business goals and developing immunity against contingencies etc. It also means orienting and training the employees on how the company is going to work in a hybrid model, what are the channels of communication, how to effectively collaborate with teams, what are the various policies in place with regard to hybrid working, teaching new software and applications that are necessary to perform hybrid working, teaching aspects of communication to ensure that there is no misinterpretation and as well aspects like using the right tone and platform for communication, communicating to various levels of management etc.

Apart from these aspects, this research can be further studied in aspects adaptability of employees to digital workplace and hybrid working

environment, measuring the successful implementation of hybrid working environment, challenges and drawbacks faced in a hybrid working environment etc.

5.3 Conclusion:

Optimizing the digital workplace with integrated technology and fully supported staff is the key to a successful hybrid work culture. Post pandemic, the future of work is hybrid and hence a careful strategy has to be planned to ensure that the hybrid working environment functions smoothly and effectively. This research gives a sneak peak into how the future looks like, how the existing facilities are with respect to hybrid infrastructure, what could be improved and how employees are coping to this new style of working especially with relation to aspects like communication and collaboration factors like data management and team management. This research gives an idea to industries transforming into hybrid working environment as to how they can get started and what are the factors to be considered.

The COVID-19 pandemic continues to have a lasting impact on the way organizations function and operate. Employers are obligated to facilitate WFH Practices, and eventually, nurture hybrid working environments. Employees are expected to maintain efficiency levels while in either of these cases. This is as challenging as it can get, due to the effect of several parameters as pointed out in the research.

Thus, as Human Resource professionals, our role in facilitating employees towards digital workplace and a hybrid working environment would be on developing strategies to ensure smooth and unanimous onboarding procedure for all employees, facilitating employees in adapting to the digital and hybrid workplace, facilitating learning and development modules that are necessary to unlearn and relearn new skills that are necessary for hybrid model, handling employee grievances and bridging gaps that arise out of hybrid working,

building various HR policies for hybrid working and building Human resource strategies that align with the overall organizational strategy to ensure that the productivity and profitability of the company remains intact despite the new shift towards digital workplace and hybrid working environment.

APPENDIX

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QUESTIONNAIRE

DIGITAL WORKPLACE MANAGEMENT IN A HYBRID WORKING ENVIRONMENT ACROSS SERVICE SECTOR

Dear respondent,

I am Ravina Narayanan, a final year student pursuing MA HRM from Madras School of Social Work. I am conducting this survey to study the impact of hybrid working environment on workplace management in the service sector. Your Participation will last approximately 5-8 minutes. Please read each statement carefully before answering a question.

This survey is purely for academic purpose only and all the information provided by you will be handled with great deal of caution and confidentiality.

1. Age:
 - a) 20-25 years
 - b) 26-30 years
 - c) 31-36 years
 - d) 36 and above
2. Work experience:
 - a) 0-3 years
 - b) 4-7 years
 - c) 8-10 years
 - d) Above 10 years

S.No	Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1	Digital technology in my workplace benefits the customer/client and gives them value					
2	I am able to maintain ethics and am able to access and use data in the digital workplace					

3	There is integrity in the process even though workplace is managed digitally					
4	I am able to interact well and on time with my teammates through digital technology					
5	I am able to share my ideas and opinions properly through digital technology					
6	Systems of accountability are in place even though the workplace is digital					
7	The performance and productivity are intact even though the workplace has shifted digitally					
8	The digital workplace and collaboration tools are usable in terms of consistency in use, documentation and responsiveness					
9	The digital workplace is reliable for business continuity					
10	The digital workplace provides accurate data for carrying out work					

11	I am able to communicate/interact directly or indirectly to the top management if needed in a digital workplace					
12	I am able to communicate/interact directly or indirectly to the middle management if needed in a digital workplace					
13	I am able to communicate/interact directly or indirectly to the first level management if needed in a digital workplace					
14	I am able to communicate/interact directly or indirectly to the customers or clients if needed in a digital workplace					
15	The information systems have adequate throughput – the maximum rate of production or the maximum rate at which something can be processed.					
16	The information systems have too much information and not accurate.					
17	The information systems contain					

	information that is in a useful format					
18	Data in the information system is flexible					
19	The cost to implement and sustain the information system is too high					
20	The digital workplace is not easy to learn and use					
21	The digital workplace system is flexible to new or exceptional situations and changes					
22	My company processes data lawfully and transparently, ensuring fairness towards the individuals					
23	My company ensures that the data held is accurate and kept up-to-date					
24	In the digital workplace, I am confident that my co-workers do not spread unverified information on social media – especially those that do nothing but provoke fear in the community					

25	In the digital workplace, my company understands and comply with the data and privacy law about confidential information					
26	My company provides me with necessary infrastructure for setting up my office at home					
27	My company has invested adequately in collaboration tools					
28	My company has implemented software like sales management systems, management reporting systems, HRM systems, executive information systems etc. that are equally accessible to both in office and remote workers					